



RFP #061726
REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS
for
Enterprise Artificial Intelligence: Platforms, Services, and Integrated Delivery
Proposal Due Date: June 17, 2026, 3:30 p.m., Central Time

Sourcewell, a State of Minnesota local government unit and service cooperative, is requesting proposals for Enterprise Artificial Intelligence: Platforms, Services, and Integrated Delivery to result in a procurement solution for use by its Participating Entities. Sourcewell Participating Entities include thousands of governmental, higher education, K-12 education, nonprofit, tribal government, and other public agencies located in the United States and Canada. Sourcewell encourages the use of Small, Minority-owned, Women's Business Enterprise, Veteran-owned Business Enterprise (S/M/WBE/VBE) suppliers both as prime and subcontractors and encourages the participation of these suppliers in the solicitation process. A full copy of the Request for Proposals can be found on the Sourcewell Procurement Portal [<https://proportal.sourcewell-mn.gov>]. Only proposals submitted through the Sourcewell Procurement Portal will be considered. Proposals are due no later than June 17, 2026, at 3:30 p.m. Central Time, and late proposals will not be considered.

SOLICITATION SCHEDULE

Public Notice of RFP Published:	April 29, 2026
Pre-proposal Conference:	May 12, 2026, 10:00 a.m., Central Time
Question Submission Deadline:	June 09, 2026, 4:30 p.m., Central Time
Proposal Due Date:	June 17, 2026, 3:30 p.m., Central Time Late responses will not be considered.
Opening:	June 17, 2026, 3:30 p.m., Central Time See RFP Section V.G. "Opening"

I. ABOUT SOURCEWELL

A. SOURCEWELL

Sourcewell is a State of Minnesota local government unit and service cooperative created under the laws of the State of Minnesota (Minnesota Statutes Section 123A.21) that facilitates a competitive public solicitation and master agreement award process for the benefit of its 50,000+ participating entities across the United States and Canada. Sourcewell's solicitation process complies with State of Minnesota law and policies, conforms to Canadian trade agreements (including Canadian Free Trade Agreement, Ontario-Quebec Trade and Cooperation Agreement, and Canada-European Union Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement, as applicable), and results in cooperative purchasing solutions from which Sourcewell's Participating Entities procure equipment, products, and services.

Cooperative purchasing provides participating entities and suppliers increased administrative efficiencies and the power of combined purchasing volume that result in overall cost savings. At times, Sourcewell also partners with other purchasing cooperatives to combine the purchasing volume of their membership into a single solicitation and master agreement expanding the reach of awarded suppliers' potential pool of end users.

Sourcewell uses a website-based platform, the Sourcewell Procurement Portal, through which all proposals to this RFP must be submitted.

B. USE OF RESULTING MASTER AGREEMENTS

In the United States, Sourcewell's master agreements are available for use by:

- Federal and state government entities¹;
- Cities, towns, and counties/parishes;
- Education service cooperatives;
- K-12 and higher education entities;
- Tribal government entities;
- Some nonprofit entities; and
- Other public entities.

The following entities are listed in this solicitation to satisfy the procurement requirements of Oregon, Utah, and Virginia [[Political Subdivision List - Oregon, Utah, and Virginia](#)].

In Canada, Sourcewell's master agreements are available for use by current and future members including:

¹ Pursuant to HAR §3-128-2, the State of Hawaii, Department of Accounting and General Services, State Procurement Office, on behalf of the State of Hawaii and participating jurisdictions, has provided notice of its Intent to Participate in the solicitation as a participating entity.

- Federal, provincial, and territorial government departments, ministries, agencies, boards, councils, committees, commissions, and similar agencies;
- Indigenous self-governing bodies;
- Regional, local, district, and other forms of municipal government, municipal organizations, school boards, and publicly funded academic, health, and social service entities referred to as MASH sector (this should be construed to include but not be limited to the cities of Calgary, Edmonton, Toronto, Ottawa, and Winnipeg), as well as any corporation or entity owned or controlled by one or more of the preceding entities;
- Crown corporations, government enterprises, and other entities that are owned or controlled by these entities through ownership interest; and
- Canoe procurement group of Canada's current and future members. Canoe members include:
 - Federal, provincial and territorial government departments, ministries, agencies, boards, councils, committees, commissions, and similar agencies;
 - Crown corporations, government enterprises, and other entities that are owned or controlled by these entities through ownership interest;
 - Indigenous self-governing bodies;
 - Airport authorities;
 - Regional, local, district, and other forms of municipal government, municipal organizations, school boards, and publicly funded academic, health, and social service entities referred to as MASH sector (this should be construed to include but not be limited to the cities of Calgary, Edmonton, Toronto, Ottawa, and Winnipeg), as well as any corporation or entity owned or controlled by one or more of the preceding entities; and
 - Canoe procurement group of Canada's current and future partner associations, including Saskatchewan Association of Rural Municipalities, Association of Manitoba Municipalities, Local Authorities Services/Association of Municipalities Ontario, Nova Scotia Federation of Municipalities, Federation of Prince Edward Island Municipalities, Municipalities Newfoundland Labrador, Union of New Brunswick Municipalities, Northwest Territories Association of Communities, Association of Yukon Communities, CivicInfo BC, Association and their current and future members.

For a listing of current United States and Canadian Participating Entities visit Sourcewell's website (note: there is a tab for each country): <https://www.sourcewell-mn.gov/sourcewell-for-vendors/agency-locator>.

Participating Entities typically access master agreements for equipment, products, or services through a purchase order issued directly to the awarded supplier. A Participating Entity may request additional terms or conditions related to a purchase. Use of Sourcewell master agreements is voluntary and Participating Entities retain the right to obtain similar equipment, products, or services from other sources.

To meet Participating Entities' needs, Sourcewell broadly publishes public notice of all solicitation opportunities, including this RFP. In addition, where applicable, other purchasing cooperatives and procurement officials receive notice and are encouraged to re-post the solicitation opportunity.

Proof of publication will be available at the conclusion of the solicitation process.

Sourcewell encourages the use of Small, Minority-owned, Women's Business Enterprise, Veteran-owned Business Enterprise (S/M/WBE/VBE) suppliers both as prime and subcontractors and encourages the participation of these suppliers in the solicitation process.

C. INTERGOVERNMENTAL SUPPORT AGREEMENTS

Pursuant to 10 U.S.C. § 2679, United States Department of Defense authorized installations may access Sourcewell's awarded cooperative purchasing master agreements through an Intergovernmental Support Agreement with Sourcewell. All transactions completed through this Intergovernmental Support program are directly facilitated by Sourcewell and may be subject to additional terms and conditions.

II. SOLICITATION DETAILS

A. SOLUTIONS-BASED SOLICITATION

This RFP and master agreement award process is a solutions-based solicitation; meaning that Sourcewell is seeking equipment, products, or services that meet the general requirements of the scope of this RFP and are commonly desired or are required by law or industry standards. Participating Entities are responsible for conducting due diligence and ensuring compliance with state, federal, local laws, and specific funding requirements in consultation with legal counsel.

B. REQUESTED EQUIPMENT, PRODUCTS, OR SERVICES

Proposers are expected to offer a wide array of equipment, products, or services at lower prices and with better value than what they would ordinarily offer to a single government entity, school district, or regional cooperative.

Sourcewell is seeking proposals for Enterprise Artificial Intelligence: Platforms, Services, and Integrated Delivery as described below.

Sourcewell recognizes that enterprise artificial intelligence solutions often rely on related capabilities such as data infrastructure, cybersecurity, and compliance. Proposers may include directly related products and services to the extent that they are complementary to the Primary Lot being proposed, even where those offerings are not exclusively AI specific, provided they align with the scope of the Solicitation.

This RFP is organized into three (3) response Lots. Proposers must select ONE (1) Primary Lot under which to submit a response.

- For purposes of this RFP, “**Primary Lot**” means the single Lot that best represents the proposer’s principal line of business and the primary value the proposer provides to Participating Entities under this solicitation.

The Proposer’s Lot selection will determine the response pool in which the proposal is evaluated. **Proposers will not be penalized for complementary offerings or capabilities that may also align with other Lots; the Lot structure serves only as an organizational and evaluation mechanism and does not limit the scope of a proposer’s broader capabilities.**

Proposals submitted in response to this Solicitation will be evaluated on a Lot-by-Lot basis. The issuance of awards may occur at different times for each Lot, and Sourcewell reserves the right to evaluate, negotiate, and award contracts for any Lot independently of the others.

Notwithstanding the timing of any individual contract award, all master agreements awarded under this Solicitation shall share a common expiration date and shall be coterminous.

Lot Selection Guidance

The following guidance is provided to assist proposers in selecting the most appropriate, single, *Primary* Lot for their response. This section is intended for clarification purposes only and does not modify or replace the requirements of this Solicitation.

Primary Deliverable Determination

Based on the definition above, proposers should consider the nature of their offering:

1. If the proposer’s Primary deliverable is a technology product, such as an AI platform, infrastructure system, or software solution that Participating Entities procure and operate, the proposer should respond under Lot 1: AI Products and Platforms.
2. If the proposer’s Primary deliverable is human expertise, including advisory, consulting, implementation, or managed services, the proposer should respond under Lot 2: AI Professional Services.
3. If (a) the proposer delivers **both** AI technology and AI professional services as a unified commercial offering, and (b) can serve as the single accountable party **for both** under one contract, and (c) maintains primary responsibility for the design, integration, performance, and delivery of the integrated AI solution, and remains fully accountable for outcomes, even when third-party components are used, the proposer should respond under Lot 3: Integrated AI Delivery.

Lot 1: AI Products and Platforms

Included Solutions may consist of, but are not limited to:

a. **AI Platforms and Infrastructure**

- i. Enterprise AI platforms with built-in automation, orchestration, and governance capabilities;
- ii. Platforms supporting AI model development, deployment, and lifecycle management for enterprise and public sector use cases;
- iii. On-premise, hybrid, and cloud AI infrastructure design, deployment, and management;
- iv. AI-optimized compute infrastructure;
- v. Enterprise knowledge management systems and data infrastructure that enable AI capabilities; and
- vi. AI solutions designed for sensitive or restricted government environments, including air-gapped and privacy-preserving deployments.

b. **Intelligent Automation Platforms and Agentic AI**

- i. Agentic AI platforms that build, deploy, and manage AI-driven automation that operate across enterprise systems independent of any single software application — including agent development frameworks, orchestration infrastructure, and lifecycle management tools;
- ii. Workflow automation platforms that connect AI capabilities to systems, data sources, and processes across organizational boundaries;
- iii. Enterprise automation platforms enhanced with AI reasoning and natural language capabilities that operate across multiple systems; and
- iv. Platforms for document intelligence, multimodal processing, and unstructured data extraction at enterprise scale.

*For purposes of this solicitation, an **AI platform** is a technology system that provides foundational infrastructure, tooling, or services enabling the development, deployment, operation, or management of artificial intelligence capabilities at enterprise scale. An AI platform is defined by the functions it performs, not by specific technologies or terminology, and is characterized by one or more of the following:*

- **Model Infrastructure**

The platform hosts, serves, or provides access to artificial intelligence models and provides mechanisms for model versioning, performance management, and lifecycle management.

- **Development and Deployment Tooling**

The platform provides tools for building, configuring, evaluating, deploying, and maintaining AI-enabled systems or applications, including data pipeline management and integration capabilities.

- **Orchestration and Automation**

The platform coordinates AI capabilities, intelligent automation, or automated workflows across enterprise systems, data sources, and operational processes.

- **Purpose-Built AI Platforms**

The platform delivers AI-enabled functionality designed for a specific industry,

government function, or operational domain, operating as a distinct, separately-procured technology independent of any single enterprise software application.

Lot 1 includes both horizontal AI platforms applicable across multiple industries and purpose-built AI platforms designed for specific government functions, industries, or operational domains, provided the platform is enterprise-scale.

Artificial intelligence should constitute a primary, standalone component of the proposer's offering or proposed solution. A standalone AI platform is an independent, purpose-built system that delivers artificial intelligence capabilities as a primary function, rather than a feature embedded within existing software applications. It operates as a modular solution that can integrate with multiple systems and data sources across an organization.

Lot 2: AI Professional Services

Included Solutions may consist of, but are not limited to:

a. AI Strategy, Governance, and Enterprise Transformation

- i. Enterprise AI maturity assessment — structured evaluation of an organization's AI readiness across technology, data, talent, governance, and culture dimensions;
- ii. Responsible AI policy development — documented frameworks, policies, and standards governing AI use, accountability, and risk management;
- iii. AI governance architecture — design and implementation of oversight structures, audit mechanisms, bias controls, and human-in-the-loop requirements;
- iv. Operating model redesign — restructuring of organizational workflows, roles, and accountabilities around AI-enabled capabilities;
- v. AI investment prioritization and business case development — structured approaches to identifying, evaluating, and sequencing AI opportunities;
- vi. Workforce transformation strategy — design of AI literacy programs, role transition planning, and organizational change management at scale; and
- vii. Cross-sector AI policy advisory — guidance on compliance with applicable federal, state, and local AI governance requirements and emerging regulatory frameworks.

b. AI-Enabled Managed Services

- i. AI operations management, including deployment oversight, incident response, and service level management;
- ii. Model monitoring — ongoing tracking of AI system performance, accuracy, and output quality in production environments;
- iii. Model drift management — detection and remediation of accuracy degradation as real-world data diverges from training data over time;
- iv. Continuous improvement programs — structured processes for model retraining, capability expansion, and performance optimization;
- v. Managed AI services for specific government functions, including citizen services automation, benefits processing, case management, and permitting; and

- vi. AI security operations — monitoring for adversarial inputs, data poisoning, and unauthorized model access.

c. AI Software Development and Engineering

Custom development of AI-enabled applications, integrations, and automated workflows designed for specific government functions, operational domains, or agency use cases, including model fine-tuning and adaptation.

For purposes of this Solicitation, custom development, software engineering, and client-specific solution design are considered professional services, even when resulting in a deployed AI-enabled application or system.

Lot 3: Integrated AI Delivery

Included Solutions may include, but are not limited to:

- a. Systems integrators delivering end-to-end AI solutions, including platform implementation, integration, and ongoing managed services;
- b. Technology companies with established professional service arms that deploy and support their own AI platforms;
- c. Managed service providers delivering AI platforms and ongoing operations as a unified service offering; and
- d. Providers delivering turnkey AI solutions for specific government functions, including both the underlying technology and ongoing service delivery.

A proposer would respond in Lot 3 **only** if they are a single organization capable of:

- i. Delivering both AI technology products and AI professional services under one contract;
- ii. Serving as the primary accountable party for both; and
- iii. Maintaining primary responsibility for the design, integration, performance, and delivery of the integrated AI solution, remaining fully accountable for outcomes, even when third-party components are used.

The ability to deliver both technology and services does not, by itself, qualify a proposer for Lot 3; the integration of these components must be a standard, unified offering for which the proposer assumes end-to-end accountability.

Unlike Lot 1 proposers, who primarily deliver technology, or Lot 2 proposers who primarily deliver services, Lot 3 proposers deliver both as a unified, integrated offering in which the technology and services components are core to the proposer's business model and are commercially established.

Lot 3 proposers should demonstrate that:

- i. Both the AI technology and professional services components are core offerings of the organization (not incidental or ad hoc);
- ii. The proposer can deliver these as integrated components; and
- iii. The proposer assumes primary responsibility for the performance, implementation, and outcomes of the combined solution.

Offerings that rely primarily on reselling or distributing third-party AI products without providing integrated implementation and accountability for outcomes do not meet the intent of this Lot.

C. ROLLING SUPPLIER ONBOARDING

Consistent with Sourcewell's commitment to providing Participating Entities with access to the best available AI solutions throughout the master agreement term, Sourcewell may conduct supplemental supplier onboarding evaluations during the **ten-year term** of the resulting master agreements.

- Future supplemental supplier onboarding evaluations will be subject to the same evaluation factors and terms as this RFP, including the **ten-year maximum** Master Agreement term and **coterminous termination date** applicable to all master agreements awarded under this RFP.
- Future supplemental supplier onboarding evaluations will be evaluated only against other suppliers responding in the same Lot, not against prior submissions or previously awarded suppliers.
- Existing awardees are not required to reapply through a supplemental evaluation window, and their master agreements remain in effect. Suppliers who previously responded to a Lot but were not awarded must resubmit during future supplemental onboarding to be considered.
- Sourcewell may re-open any Lot every six months to consider additional responses. Sourcewell reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to suspend, delay, or discontinue further rolling supplier onboarding for any Lot as Sourcewell deems appropriate, including based on the best interests of Participating Entities, administrative capacity, or other operational considerations. Sourcewell reserves the right to open any, all, or no Lots at the time of any rolling supplier onboarding.

D. SINGLE PRIMARY LOT

Proposers must select ONE Primary Lot (1, 2, or 3) in which to submit their proposal. For purposes of this RFP, "**Primary**" means the single Lot that best represents the proposer's principal line of business and the primary value the proposer provides to Participating Entities under this solicitation. Lot selection is the proposer's determination and reflects how they primarily create value for Participating Entities. If a proposer submits a response that does not clearly fit the selected Primary Lot, Sourcewell reserves the right to seek clarification from a

proposer and reassign the submission to the most appropriate Lot, or deem it non-responsive, based on such clarification.

Sourcewell prefers suppliers that provide a sole source of responsibility for the equipment, products, and services provided under a resulting master agreement. If proposer includes the equipment, products, and services of its subsidiary entities, the proposer must also identify all subsidiaries included in its proposal. If proposer requires the use of distributors, dealers, resellers, or subcontractors to provide the equipment, products, or services, the proposal must address how the equipment, products or services will be provided to Participating Entities, and describe the network of distributors, dealers, resellers, and/or subcontractors that will be available to serve Participating Entities under a resulting master agreement.

Sourcewell encourages suppliers to offer the broadest possible selection of equipment, products, and services being proposed over the largest possible geographic area and to the largest possible cross-section of Sourcewell current and future Participating Entities.

E. REQUIREMENTS

It is expected that proposers have knowledge of all applicable industry standards, laws, and regulations and possess an ability to market and distribute the equipment, products, or services to Participating Entities.

1. Safety Requirements. All items proposed must comply with current applicable safety or regulatory standards or codes.
2. Deviation from Industry Standard. Deviations from industry standards must be identified with an explanation of how the equipment, products, and services will provide equivalent function, coverage, performance, and/or related services.
3. New Equipment and Products. Proposed equipment and products must be for new, current model; however, proposer may offer certain close-out equipment or products if it is specifically noted in the Pricing proposal.
4. Delivered and operational. Unless clearly noted in the proposal, equipment and products must be delivered to the Participating Entity as operational.
5. Warranty. All equipment, products, supplies, and services must be covered by a warranty that is the industry standard or better.

F. PROSPECTIVE MASTER AGREEMENT TERM

The term of the Master Agreement will be **ten (10) years** with no extensions. Sourcewell reserves the right to consider additional extensions beyond the ten-year term as required under exceptional circumstances and mutual agreement. Notwithstanding the timing of any individual master agreement award, all master agreements awarded under this Solicitation shall share a common expiration date and shall be coterminous.

G. ESTIMATED MASTER AGREEMENT VALUE AND USAGE

Based on past volume of similar contracts, the estimated annual value of all transactions from master agreements resulting from this RFP is anticipated to be USD \$150 Million for Lot 1, \$150 Million for Lot 2, and \$300 Million for Lot 3. Therefore, proposers are expected to propose volume pricing. Sourcewell anticipates considerable activity under the master agreement(s) awarded from this RFP; however, sales and sales volume from any resulting master agreement are not guaranteed.

H. MARKETING PLAN

Proposer's sales force will be the primary source of communication with Participating Entities. The proposer's Marketing Plan should demonstrate proposer's ability to deploy a sales force or dealer network to Participating Entities, as well as proposer's sales and service capabilities. It is expected that proposer will promote and market any master agreement award.

I. ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

1. Master agreements will be awarded to proposers able to best meet the needs of Participating Entities. Proposers should submit their complete line of equipment, products, or services that are applicable to the scope of this RFP.
2. A proposer may submit only one proposal. If related, affiliated, or subsidiary entities elect to submit separate proposals, rather than a single parent-entity proposal, each such proposal must be prepared independently and without cooperation, collaboration, or collusion.
3. If a proposer works with a consultant on its proposal, the consultant (an individual or company) may not assist any other entity with a proposal for this solicitation.
4. Proposers should include all relevant information in its proposal, since Sourcewell cannot consider information that is not included in the proposal. Sourcewell reserves the right to verify proposer's information and may request clarification from a proposer, including samples of the proposed equipment or products.
5. Depending upon the responses received in a given category, Sourcewell may need to organize responses into subcategories in order to provide the broadest coverage of the requested equipment, products, or services to Participating Entities. Awards may be based on a subcategory.
6. A proposer's documented negative past performance with Sourcewell or its Participating Entities occurring under a previously awarded Sourcewell master agreement may be considered in the evaluation of a proposal.

III. PRICING AND DELIVERY SCHEDULES

A. REQUIREMENTS

Sourcewell recognizes that enterprise AI solutions are delivered through fundamentally different commercial models. Proposers are expected to propose pricing structures appropriate to their Primary Lot and the nature of their offering **and upload a corresponding detailed price sheet.**

All proposed pricing must be:

1. Submitted using one or more of the following pricing structures, as appropriate to the proposer's Primary Lot and commercial model*:
 - a. **Line-Item Pricing** — Pricing based on each individual product, platform, or service. Each line must indicate the proposer's published list price and the Master Agreement Price. Applicable where discrete, individually priced products or services are offered.
 - b. **Percentage Discount from Catalog or Published Rate Card** — A percentage discount applied to a published rate card, MSRP, or catalog price. Proposers are responsible for providing and maintaining current published rates with Sourcewell throughout the term of any resulting master agreement. This pricing must be included in the proposal and updated as rate cards change.
 - c. **Subscription and Consumption-Based Pricing** — For AI platforms, models, and infrastructure delivered on a recurring or usage-based basis. Proposals must identify the pricing unit (e.g., per user/month, per API call, per compute unit, per model inference, per transaction) and the not-to-exceed rate for each unit. Where consumption pricing is tiered, all tiers must be disclosed.
 - d. **Managed Services and Recurring Fees** — For ongoing AI operations, model monitoring, and managed services delivered under a recurring engagement. Proposals must fully describe the pricing model, billing basis, scope of included services, and any assumptions, limitations, tiers, minimums, or other conditions affecting the proposed pricing (for example, pricing per month, per environment, per model, per user, by service tier, or under a fixed recurring fee arrangement).
 - e. **Time-and-Materials Rates** — For professional services, implementation, advisory, and custom development. Proposals must provide not-to-exceed hourly or daily rates by role, labor category, or service type.
 - f. **Outcome- or Transaction-Based Pricing** — For solutions priced per task completed, case resolved, or decision processed. Proposals must identify the unit of outcome, the not-to-exceed rate per unit, and any volume thresholds that affect per-unit pricing.
 - g. **Other** — does not fit within the models above. Proposer must fully describe their pricing model.

**Note on Pricing Model Selection: Proposers are not required to only use a single pricing model.*

2. Selected Bid Pricing Line Items - In addition to 1(a) through 1(g) above, Sourcewell is requesting selected bid pricing items to assist in preparation of the independent estimate and cost/price analysis.

3. The proposer's not to exceed price. A not to exceed price is the highest price for which equipment, products, or services may be billed to a Participating Entity. However, it is permissible for suppliers to sell at a price that is lower than the agreed-upon price.
4. Stated in U.S. and Canadian dollars (as applicable).
5. Clearly understandable, complete, and fully describe the total cost of acquisition (e.g., the cost of the proposed equipment, products, and services delivered and operational for its intended purpose in the Participating Entity's location).

Proposers should clearly identify any costs that are NOT included in the proposed product or service pricing. This may include items such as installation, set up, mandatory training, or initial inspection. Include identification of any parties that impose such costs and their relationship to the proposer. Additionally, proposers should clearly describe any unique distribution and/or delivery methods or options offered in the proposal.

B. PRICING TRANSPARENCY REQUIREMENTS

Given the complexity and variability of AI pricing, all proposals **must** also include a Pricing Narrative – a plain language explanation of:

- How costs scale over time as usage, users, or data volumes grow;
- What events or conditions may trigger pricing changes during the contract term (e.g., model updates, infrastructure changes, licensing tier adjustments); and
- How a Participating Entity can reasonably estimate total cost of ownership over a multi-year engagement.

The Pricing Narrative is not a substitute for the structured price sheet required above — it is a supplement that allows evaluators and Participating Entities to assess the full economic picture.

C. ADMINISTRATIVE FEES

Proposers awarded a master agreement are expected to pay Sourcewell an administrative fee in exchange for Sourcewell facilitating the resulting master agreements. The administrative fee is normally calculated as a percentage of the total sales to Participating Entities for all equipment, products, or services made during a calendar quarter, and is typically one percent (1%) to two percent (2%). In some categories, a flat fee may be an acceptable alternative.

D. DELIVERY SCHEDULES

Participating Entities are encouraged to establish flexible delivery schedules whenever feasible with the awarded supplier.

IV. MASTER AGREEMENT

Proposers awarded a master agreement will be required to execute a master agreement with Sourcwell (see attached template). Only those modifications the proposer indicates in its proposal will be available for discussion. Much of the language in the master agreement reflects Minnesota legal requirements and cannot be altered. Numerous and/or onerous exceptions that contradict Minnesota law may result in the proposal being disqualified from further review and evaluation. Additionally, if a Participating Entities use an awarded master agreement for FEMA or other federal grant purchases, terms and conditions required by 2 C.F.R. §200.327 and Appendix II to 2 C.F.R §200 are incorporated into the master agreement. These terms and conditions cannot be altered.

To identify any exception, or to request any modification, to Sourcwell's standard master agreement terms, conditions, or specifications, a proposer must submit the proposed exception(s) or requested modification(s) via redline in the Master Agreement Template provided in the "Documents" section of the "Bid Details" page on the Sourcwell Procurement Portal and uploaded as part of its response. Only those exceptions noted at the time of the proposal submission will be considered.

Exceptions must:

1. Clearly identify the affected article and section.
2. Clearly note the requested modification; and as applicable, provide requested alternative language.

Unclear requests will be automatically denied.

Only those exceptions that have been accepted by Sourcwell will be included in the master agreement document provided to the awarded supplier for signature.

If a proposer receives a master agreement award resulting from this solicitation it will have up to 30 days to sign and return the master agreement. After that time, at Sourcwell's sole discretion, the master agreement award may be revoked.

V. RFP PROCESS

A. PRE-PROPOSAL CONFERENCE

Sourcwell will hold an optional, non-mandatory pre-proposal conference via webcast on the date and time noted in the Solicitation Schedule for this RFP and on the Sourcwell Procurement Portal. The purpose of this conference is to allow potential proposers to ask questions regarding this RFP and Sourcwell's competitive procurement process. Information about the webcast will be sent to all entities that have registered for this solicitation opportunity through their Sourcwell Procurement Portal Vendor Account. Pre-proposal conference attendance is optional.

B. QUESTIONS REGARDING THIS RFP AND ORAL COMMUNICATION

All questions regarding this RFP must be submitted through the Sourcewell Procurement Portal. The deadline for submission of questions is found in the Solicitation Schedule and on the Sourcewell Procurement Portal. Answers to questions will be issued through an addendum to this RFP. Repetitive questions will be summarized into a single answer and identifying information will be removed from the submitted questions.

All questions, whether specific to a proposer or generally related to the RFP, must be submitted using this process. Do not contact individual Sourcewell staff to ask questions or request information as this may disqualify the proposer from responding to this RFP. Sourcewell will not respond to questions submitted after the deadline.

C. ADDENDA

Sourcewell may modify this RFP at any time prior to the proposal due date by issuing an addendum. Addenda issued by Sourcewell become a part of the RFP and will be delivered to potential proposers through the Sourcewell Procurement Portal. Sourcewell accepts no liability in connection with the delivery of any addenda.

Before a proposal will be accepted through the Sourcewell Procurement Portal, all addenda, if any, must be acknowledged by the proposer by checking the box for each addendum. It is the responsibility of the proposer to check for any addenda that may have been issued up to the solicitation due date and time.

If an addendum is issued after a proposer submitted its proposal, the Sourcewell Procurement Portal will WITHDRAW the submission and change the proposer's proposal status to INCOMPLETE. The proposer can view this status change in the "MY BIDS" section of the Sourcewell Procurement Portal Vendor Account. The proposer is solely responsible to check the "MY BIDS" section of the Sourcewell Procurement Portal Vendor Account periodically after submitting its proposal (and up to the Proposal Due Date). If the proposer's proposal status has changed to INCOMPLETE, the proposer is solely responsible to:

1. make any required adjustments to its proposal;
2. acknowledge the addenda; and
3. ensure the re-submitted proposal is received through the Sourcewell Procurement Portal no later than the Proposal Due Date and time shown in the Solicitation Schedule above.

D. PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

Proposer's complete proposal must be submitted through the Sourcewell Procurement Portal no later than the date and time specified in the Solicitation Schedule. Any other form of proposal submission, whether electronic, paper, or otherwise, will not be considered by Sourcewell. **Late proposals will not be considered.** It is the proposer's sole responsibility to ensure that the proposal is received on time.

It is recommended that proposers allow sufficient time to upload the proposal and to resolve any issues that may arise. The time and date that a proposal is received by Sourcewell is solely determined by the Sourcewell Procurement Portal web clock.

In the event of problems with the Sourcewell Procurement Portal, follow the instructions for technical support posted in the portal. It may take up to 24 hours to respond to certain issues.

Upon successful submission of a proposal, the Sourcewell Procurement Portal will automatically generate a confirmation email to the proposer. If the proposer does not receive a confirmation email, contact Sourcewell's support provider at support@bidsandtenders.ca.

To ensure receipt of the latest information and updates via email regarding this solicitation, or if the proposer has obtained this solicitation document from a third party, the onus is on the proposer to create a Sourcewell Procurement Portal Vendor Account and register for this solicitation opportunity.

Within the Sourcewell Procurement Portal, all proposals must be digitally acknowledged by an authorized representative of the proposer attesting that the information contained in the proposal is true and accurate. By submitting a proposal, proposer warrants that the information provided is true, correct, and reliable for purposes of evaluation for potential master agreement award. The submission of inaccurate, misleading, or false information is grounds for disqualification from a master agreement award and may subject the proposer to remedies available by law.

E. GENERAL PROPOSAL REQUIREMENTS

Proposals must be:

1. In substantial compliance with the requirements of this RFP or it will be considered nonresponsive and be rejected.
2. Complete. A proposal will be rejected if it is conditional or incomplete.
3. Submitted in English.
4. Valid and irrevocable for 150 days following the Proposal Due Date.

Any and all costs incurred in responding to this RFP will be borne by the proposer.

F. PROPOSAL WITHDRAWAL

Prior to the proposal deadline, a proposer may withdraw its proposal.

G. OPENING

The Opening of proposals will be conducted in the Sourcewell Procurement Portal immediately following the proposal due date and time. To view the list of proposers resulting from the

opening, verify that the Sourcewell Procurement Portal opportunities list search is set to “All” or “Closed.”

Members of the public may attend the Opening at Sourcewell’s office located at 202 12th Street NE, Staples, MN to hear the results.

VI. EVALUATION AND AWARD

A. EVALUATION

It is the intent of Sourcewell to award one or more master agreements to responsive and responsible proposers offering the best overall quality, selection of equipment, products, and services, and price that meet the commonly requested specifications of Sourcewell and its Participating Entities. The award(s) will be limited to the number of proposers that Sourcewell determines is necessary to meet the needs of its Participating Entities.

Proposals submitted in response to this Solicitation will be evaluated on a Lot-by-Lot basis. The issuance of awards may occur at different times for each Lot, and Sourcewell reserves the right to evaluate, negotiate, and award contracts for any Lot independently of the others.

Factors to be considered in determining the number of master agreements to be awarded in any category may include the following:

1. Total evaluation scores (considering natural breaks in the scoring of responsive proposals);
2. The number and geographic location of highest-scoring proposers that offer:
 - a. A comprehensive selection of the requested equipment, products, or services;
 - b. A sales and service network ensuring availability and coverage for Participating Entities’ use; and
 - c. Other attributes of the proposer or contents of its proposal that assist Participating Entities in achieving environmental and social requirements, and goals.

Information submitted as part of a proposal should be as specific as possible when responding to the RFP. Do not assume Sourcewell has any knowledge about a specific supplier or product.

Responsiveness Criteria

To qualify as responsive under this RFP, a Proposer must demonstrate experience delivering artificial intelligence solutions in a highly regulated industry at a scale appropriate to the selected Lot. The required thresholds are identified and explained at the beginning of the RFP Questionnaire in the Sourcewell Procurement Portal, and will be evaluated during a responsiveness review, which constitutes the first step of the evaluation process.

- Highly regulated industries are sectors subject to strict government oversight, compliance standards, and legal requirements to ensure safety, security, and ethical practices.
- Qualifying highly regulated industries include, but are not limited to: banking and financial services, insurance, healthcare and public health, federal, state, local, or tribal government, K–12 or higher education, public safety and criminal justice, public transportation and transit authorities, utilities and energy (where government-operated or regulated), and defense and national security. *Whether an industry qualifies as highly regulated for the purposes of this RFP will be determined at the sole discretion of the evaluation team*

B. AWARD(S)

Award(s) will be made to the highest-scoring proposer(s) whose proposal conforms to all conditions and requirements of the RFP, and consistent with the award criteria defined in this RFP.

Proposals submitted in response to this Solicitation will be evaluated on a Lot-by-Lot basis. The issuance of awards may occur at different times for each Lot, and Sourcewell reserves the right to evaluate, negotiate, and award contracts for any Lot independently of the others.

Sourcewell may request written clarification of a proposal at any time during the evaluation process.

Proposal evaluation will be based on the following scoring criteria and the Sourcewell Evaluator Scoring Guide (a copy is available in the Sourcewell Procurement Portal):

Conformance to RFP Requirements	Pass/Fail
Financial Viability and Marketplace Success	50
Ability to Sell and Deliver Solutions	175
Responsible AI & Governance	175
Marketing Plan	100
Value Added Attributes	100
Depth and Breadth of Offered Solutions	200
Pricing	200
TOTAL POINTS	1000

Sourcewell reserves the right to reduce or recalibrate the numerical evaluation scale to align with Sourcewell's then-current procurement practices. Any such adjustment will apply prospectively and uniformly to future evaluation cycles. Notwithstanding any modification to the evaluation scale, all substantive evaluation criteria and the weights assigned to those criteria will remain unchanged and will be applied consistently across all future rolling solicitations.

C. PROTESTS OF AWARDS

Any protest made under this RFP by a proposer must be in writing, in English, addressed to Sourcewell's Chief Executive Officer, and delivered to the Sourcewell office located at 202 12th Street NE, Staples, MN 56479. All documents that comprise the complete protest package must be received, and time stamped at the Sourcewell office by 3:30 p.m., Central Time, no later than 10 business days following Sourcewell's notice of master agreement non-award. A protest must allege a procedural, technical, or legal defect, with supporting documentation. A protest that merely requests a re-evaluation of a proposal's content will not be entertained.

A protest must include the following items:

- The name, address, and telephone number of the protester;
- Identification of the solicitation by RFP number;
- A precise statement of the relevant facts;
- Identification of the alleged procedural, technical, or legal defect;
- Analysis of the basis for the protest;
- Any additional supporting documentation;
- The original signature of the protester or its representative; and
- Protest bond in the amount of \$20,000 (except where prohibited by law or treaty).

Protests that do not address these elements and include all required documents will not be reviewed.

D. RIGHTS RESERVED

This RFP does not commit Sourcewell to award any master agreement, and a proposal may be rejected if it is nonresponsive, conditional, incomplete, conflicting, or misleading. Proposals that contain false statements or do not support an attribute or condition stated by the proposer may be rejected.

In addition to any other rights reserved herein, Sourcewell reserves the right to:

- Modify or cancel this RFP at any time;
- Reject any and all proposals received;
- Reject proposals that do not comply with the provisions of this RFP;
- Select, for master agreements or for discussion, a proposal other than that with the lowest cost;
- Independently verify any information provided in a proposal;
- Disqualify any proposer that does not meet the requirements of this RFP, is debarred or suspended by the United States or Canada, State of Minnesota, Participating Entity's state or province; has an officer, or other key personnel, who have been charged with a serious crime; or is bankrupt, insolvent, or where bankruptcy or insolvency are a reasonable prospect;

- Waive or modify any informalities, irregularities, or inconsistencies in the proposals received;
- Clarify any part of a proposal and discuss any aspect of the proposal with any proposer; and negotiate with more than one proposer;
- Award a master agreement if only one responsive proposal is received if it is in the best interest of Participating Entities; and
- Award a master agreement to one or more proposers if it is in the best interest of Participating Entities.

E. DISPOSITION OF PROPOSALS

All materials submitted in response to this RFP will become property of Sourcewell and will become public record in accordance with Minnesota Statutes Chapter 13, after negotiations are complete, including pricing and financial data. Sourcewell considers negotiations complete upon execution of a resulting master agreement.

Proposers are explicitly cautioned not to submit any data that they consider to be confidential, proprietary, or trade secret, as such data will not be treated as confidential and will be subject to public disclosure in accordance with Minnesota law.

F. ADDITIONAL FEDERAL FUNDING NOTICES

NOTICE TO ALL PROPOSERS

Non-Discrimination on the Basis of Faith

- Faith-based organizations may propose to this Request for Proposals on the same basis as any other organization, as set forth at, and subject to the protections and requirements of, this part and any applicable constitutional and statutory requirements, including 42 U.S.C. 2000bb et seq. Neither Sourcewell, nor any federal funding agency will discriminate for or against an organization on the basis of the organization's religious character, motives, or affiliation, or lack thereof, or on the basis of conduct that would not be considered grounds to favor or disfavor a similarly situated secular organization.
- A faith-based organization that participates in this program will retain its independence from the government and may continue to carry out its mission consistent with religious freedom and conscience protections in Federal law. Religious accommodations may also be sought under many of these religious freedom, nondiscrimination, and conscience protections in Federal law.
- A faith-based organization may not use direct Federal financial assistance from any federal funding agency to support or engage in any explicitly religious activities except when consistent with the Establishment Clause of the First Amendment and any other applicable requirements. An organization receiving Federal financial assistance also may not, in providing services funded by any Federal agency, or in their outreach activities related to such services, discriminate against a program beneficiary on the basis of

religion, a religious belief, a refusal to hold a religious belief, or a refusal to attend or participate in a religious service.

Non-Discrimination of Disadvantaged Businesses

In accordance with the provisions of Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (78 Stat. 252, 42 U.S.C. §§ 2000d to 2000d-4), Sourcewell hereby notifies all proposers that it will affirmatively ensure that disadvantaged business enterprises will be afforded full and fair opportunity to submit proposals in response to this Request for Proposals and will not be discriminated against on the grounds of race, color, or national origin in consideration for an award.

PREVIEW
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